

Sun worshippers

Most lizards are well-adapted to hot, dry conditions. Agama lizards make their homes in the grasslands or scrublands of Africa, where they can sun themselves to heat their bodies.

Grasping, prehensile tail.

Tree boas hang down headfirst

...and use sharp teeth to seize a good meal.

Coiled climber

Tree boas are good climbers, with a "prehensile" tail that grips and holds branches tightly. Longer and slimmer than ground boas, they can slide easily through the branches.



Vacation homes

Land iguanas are often found in tropical settings, where they can bask on rocks near the coast. This rock iguana (left) is taking it easy in the Bahamas.

Roommates

Lots of reptiles use underground burrows – but often for different reasons. Tortoises use them to escape hot, dry weather, skinks to run away from predators, and snakes to hunt burrowing mammals.

